HTTPie cram sheet

httpie/cli@3.2.4 (commit 5b604c3) · 2026-11-02

If you only read one thing: in scripts and CI always pass --ignore-stdin. Otherwise piped stdin becomes the request body and key=value items fail with "cannot be mixed".

Legend: ★ most used · ⚠ gotcha

REQUEST ITEMS

Item	Sends
`name=Ada` ★	JSON string (form with `-f`)
`age:=36` ★	raw JSON: number, bool, list
`X-Token:abc` ★	header; `Accept:` removes it
`q==1`	query param `?q=1`
`cv@./cv.pdf`	multipart file upload
`body:=@data.json`	JSON field from file
`'user[roles][]=admin'`	nested JSON

DAILY COMMANDS

Command	Does
`http :3000/api` ★	GET localhost:3000
`http POST api.io/u name=Ada`	JSON POST
`http -v URL` ★	show request + response
`http --offline URL a=1`	print request, don't send
`http -f POST URL a=1`	form-encoded
`http -d URL`	download to file
`https example.org`	default scheme https

OUTPUT (-P / --PRINT)

Letter	Prints
`H` / `B`	request headers / body
`h` / `b`	response headers / body
`m`	response metadata (timing)

Default on a terminal: `hb`. Piped: `b`. `--offline`: `HB`.

AUTH, REDIRECTS, SESSIONS

- `-a user:pass` basic; `-a user` prompts for password
- `-A bearer -a TOKEN` → `Authorization: Bearer TOKEN`
- `-F` follow redirects (off by default, max 30)
- `--session=dev` saves headers, auth, cookies per host

EXIT CODES

Code	Meaning
0	OK, also 4xx/5xx without `--check-status`
1	error / bad args
2	timeout
3/4/5	HTTP 3xx/4xx/5xx with `--check-status`
6 / 7	too many redirects / plugin error
130	Ctrl-C

DEV LOOP

```
python3 -m venv venv && .
venv/bin/activate
pip install -e '.[test]'
python -m pytest
tests/test_cli.py
make codestyle   # flake8
```

- one test: `pytest tests/test_x.py::TestY::test_z`
- most tests hit a local httpbin (pytest-httpbin)

WHERE CODE LIVES

- flags: `httpie/cli/definition.py`
- defaults, method guess: `cli/argparser.py`
- main loop, exit codes: `core.py`
- sending: `client.py` · output: `output/`
- flow: `raw_main` → `program` → `collect_messages` → `write_message`

CONFIG AND PLUGINS

- dir: `$HTTPIE_CONFIG_DIR`, else `~/.httpie` if present, else `~/.config/httpie` (Windows: `%APPDATA%\httpie`)
- `config.json` `{"default_options": ["--style=fruity"]}` prepends flags to every call
- sessions: `sessions/HOST/NAME.json` in that dir
- `httpie cli plugins install httpie-foo` / `list` / `uninstall`
- plugin classes: `httpie/plugins/base.py` (Auth, Transport, Converter, Formatter)

GOTCHAS

- ⚠ Method is guessed: data items or stdin → POST, else GET.
- ⚠ 4xx/5xx exit 0 by default, because only `--check-status` maps status to exit code.
- ⚠ `--download` implies `--follow`, so it saves the final redirect target.
- ⚠ Sessions never store headers starting `Content-` or `If-`; they're per request.
- ⚠ Don't edit `extras/man/*.1`: CI regenerates them on push to master.
- ⚠ Bug report? Paste `http --debug <command>` output.